

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #007 — The Secrecy Mandate
CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf
Tolerance: 0%

1. The Decision

THE SHARED UNIVERSE IS A **100% SECRET**

Nothing is announced and nothing leaks. The public discovers the universe for themselves, film by film, as it happens.

2. How This Differs From the MCU

This is a deliberate change from the blueprint. Marvel Studios told the world about its universe early. It teased the team-up at the end of its very first film and announced future release dates the same year. TMU does the opposite. We follow the MCU's **structure**, but not its **publicity**. Every film reaches the public as its own Motown Productions release.

3. What Stays Secret

Classified (internal only)	Public
The franchise name “The Motown Universe” and the “TMU” initials	Motown Productions (the studio name)
The phase structure and the 23-film plan (Memo #004)	Each film, once it is announced as a single project
The team name “The Motortown Revue” as a franchise team (Memo #006)	The Motortown Revue as a real historical tour inside the stories
The 60 / 40 story model and the Continuity Office (Memo #005)	The tagline “The Sound of Young America” (Motown’s real slogan)
Long-term casting plans and any deals for more than one film	Each film’s cast, announced film by film
The long-term plan behind the Paramount distribution deal and the Universal acquisition	The Paramount deal and the Universal acquisition as ordinary studio business news

4. Security Measures

Production

- **Codenames.** Every production has a codename on scripts, call sheets and permits. Real titles are shared only with the people who need them.
- **Locked scripts.** Scripts are watermarked to each reader. Crossover pages are redacted or handed out on set on the day they're shot.
- **Crossover scenes are sealed.** Scenes that link films are shot on closed sets with a minimal crew, and some are added late in post-production.
- **NDAs for everyone,** including cast, crew, vendors, Paramount and Universal. Casting contracts that cover more than one film are kept confidential.
- **The Continuity Office** is the only department that sees the whole master timeline.

Marketing

- Every film is sold as a **standalone music biopic**. Trailers, posters and press tours never show or mention crossovers.
- Talent is coached for press. "We're just focused on telling this artist's story" is the standard answer.
- There's no "Motown Universe" branding anywhere in public: not in credits, logos, trailers, websites or merchandise.

5. How the Public Discovers It

- **It's hidden in plain sight.** Motown's real history is connected, so shared characters and places look like ordinary historical accuracy at first. Berry Gordy, the Funk Brothers and Hitsville appearing in more than one biopic doesn't give anything away.
- **The same actor plays each person every time.** This follows the Memo #005 rule. Audiences notice that Gordy is played by the same actor in each film, and they start to wonder why.
- **Connections tighten gradually.** Phase 1 is 40 / 60 serialized to standalone, so early links stay subtle. The low serialized share in Phase 1 doubles as cover. Connections get deeper in Phase 2 and Phase 3.
- **Fans connect the dots.** Callbacks, overlapping scenes and post-credits moments reward close viewers. The public puts the universe together on their own, in real time.

6. Changes to Earlier Memos

- **Memo #001:** "The Motown Universe" is now an **internal name only**, and the "THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE" lockup is confidential until the reveal.

- **Memo #002:** the public credit line is now just “*MOTOWN PRODUCTIONS presents*”, with the “a Motown Universe film” line removed.
- **Memos #003–#006:** all content is internal and confidential.

7. Open Item

The reveal. When, and whether, Motown Productions ever confirms the universe officially, and when the name goes public, will be decided in a later memo.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios.